A-A-50876A
24 March 1989
SUPERSEDING
A-A-50876
12 August, 1983

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BATH, PARAFFIN

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-B-16946C which is cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers a paraffin bath designed to facilitate hot paraffin treatment of the body extremities to relieve the pain and discomfort of joint diseases and injuries.

Salient characteristics:

The paraffin bath shall be a bath suitable for the administration of molten paraffin heat therapy to the arm of a patient. The paraffin bath shall consist of a portable bath with cover and a mobile stand. The bath shall have the following overall dimensions, with tolerance of plus or minus 2 inches:

Height	33 inches
Width	15-1/2 inches
Length	30-1/2 inches

The portable bath shall consist of the inner tank, housing, wood base, wood top frame, cover, glides, and electrical components.

The inner tank shall be fabricated of a nickel-copper alloy sheet, not thinner than 0.024 inch thick. The fabricated tank shall be leakproof. It shall have a heated drain that permits easy paraffin removal for cleaning or replacement. The tank rim shall have a hard wood molding to insure patient's protection from the heat of the bath and the surrounding metal. The wood shall be free of splinters and rough areas.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

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The housing, stand, and cover shall be fabricated of American Iron and Steel Institute (AISI) series 300 corrosion-resisting steel, or chromium over nickel-plated carbon steel. The steel shall be a minimum of 0.024 inch thick. A handle shall be attached to the cover. The handle shall be fabricated of corrosion-resisting materials, or finished in a manner to render it corrosion-resistant. One guide shall be located in each corner of the portable bath so that the unit will bear on a flat surface when removed from the mobile stand. The mobile stand shall have four tubular legs. The legs shall have a one inch outside diameter with a minimum 0.065 inch thick wall. Each leg shall be fitted with a two inch diameter ball bearing, rubber tire wheel, swivel caster. All accessible surfaces of the bath shall be free of burrs and sharp edges.

The paraffin bath shall be equipped with two separate heating circuits, one to melt down the paraffin and the other to maintain the paraffin at the set temperature. Both circuits shall operate on 115 volts, 50/60 Hz, alternating current. The meltdown circuit shall be controlled by an interior thermostat set between 200°F and 215°F (93.3°C and 101.6°C) and a time switch having a period of 60 minutes. The temperature maintenance circuit shall be controlled by a close differential thermostat which shall maintain the temperature of the paraffin to within plus or minus one degree at any set temperature in the range of 120°F to 135°F (48.8°C to 57.2°C).

The bath shall be provided with not less than 9 feet of 3-conductor line cord. The cord shall be provided with a hospital grade attachment plug complying with UL 544 and shall comply with AISI Standard C73.11. The grounding conductor of the line cord shall be securely attached to the housing of the unit.

The paraffin bath shall be furnished complete with 53 pounds of paraffin, 1 gallon of light mineral oil, and a suitable floating dairy-type thermometer (30° to 220° F minimum range). It shall be furnished with two complete sets of instructions for operation, maintenance, and repair, together with schematics and wiring diagrams.

Workmanship. The paraffin bath shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One paraffin bath, as specified, constitutes one unit.

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Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 4.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one paraffin bath as specified in this description.

Defects.

The bath is not complete with all components.

The housing, stand, and cover are not fabricated of AISI series 300 corrosion-resisting steel, or chromium over nickel-plated carbon steel.

The inner tank is not fabricated of a nickel copper alloy sheet.

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Defects (continued).

Exposed wood surfaces are not free of splinters or rough areas.

Accessible surfaces of bath are not free of burrs and sharp edges.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests, including dimensional tests, shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-1. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one paraffin bath.

a. First article. Where a first article sample is required, all tests shall be performed on that unit.

b. Acceptance testing. When a first article sample has not been required, one unit shall be subjected to the performance test specified herein. If a test article sample has successfully passed all tests, performance test shall not be required at acceptance.

Tests

Paraffin Congealing Point. The paraffin shall be tested for its congealing point in accordance with ASTM D938. A congealing point exceeding 52.2° Celsius (C.) shall constitute a defect.

Performance Test. The unit shall be charged with paraffin and connected to a 115 volt, 50/60 Hertz (Hz) power source. The unit shall be operated on the melt down circuit until the bath temperature reaches 200°F. The temperature control shall then be increased to the maximum control adjustment and the temperature of the paraffin measured. A temperature exceeding 215°F. shall be considered cause for rejection. The unit shall then be allowed to cool until a temperature of 125°F. is reached. The maintenance thermostat shall then be set to cut in and out to maintain a temperature of 126° F within plus or minus one degree. The unit shall then be left to operate for a minimum of 3 days and the temperature shall be checked daily to determine that the unit is operating properly. Any failure to operate properly shall constitute a defect.

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Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6530-00-710-2850

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-2045

Location:
CID/BATH/PARAFFIN/H13-33

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-50876A	BATH, PARAFFIN

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION (Mark one)
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code)	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER (Specify)

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER (Last, First, MI) – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER (Include Area Code) – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code) – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION (YYMMDD)

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NOTE. This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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